

Pine Creek High School Marching Band

2026 Production: Continuum — Field Prop Operations Guide

Simplified Volunteer Handbook & Step-by-Step Competition Day Procedures

☀️ CORE PROGRAM PHILOSOPHY:

The focus is always on the kids' performance, not the props. Props exist strictly to support and enhance the visual spectacle of the students' musicianship and marching. If conditions become hazardous or timing breaks down, props are abandoned or held back without hesitation. **Nothing we do on the prop crew will ever compromise a student's safety or their competitive show.**

1. Wind Safety Plan & Mandatory NO-GO Contingencies

Because Pine Creek High School operates in the high-altitude, wind-prone environment of Colorado Springs (6,500 ft ASL) and competes in open stadium venues, wind safety controls must be understood by every Adult Volunteer before touching a prop.

🔴 ABSOLUTE WIND NO-GO THRESHOLD (>20 MPH)

HARD RULE: If sustained winds exceed 20 mph OR gusts are forecasted/reported at 25–30 mph, PROPS DO NOT LEAVE THE TRUCK/TRAILER.

Last season confirmed that props in >20 mph winds create unacceptable safety risks for students and handlers. When this threshold is met, the Prop Lead makes an immediate **NO-GO** call. Props remain securely locked in the equipment trailer or behind stadium bleachers. **The band performs a clean visual show without props.** There is no middle ground, and no emergency lay-flat abort on the field is permitted—if high winds are even possible, props stay off the turf.

Wind Regime	Wind Velocity	Duck Blind Ballasting	Backdrop Ballasting	Decision Status
🟡 Tier 0: Calm	0 – 8 mph	None	None	GO (Dry)
🟢 Tier 1: Normal	8 – 12 mph	2 bags	4 bags (2/wing post)	GO (Normal)
🟡 Tier 2: Advisory	12 – 18 mph	3 bags (2 ground + 1 hanging)	6 bags (3/wing post)	GO (With Ballast)
🟠 Tier 3: High-Wind	18 – 22 mph	4 bags (2 ground + 2 hanging)	9 bags (6 wing + 3 rear rail)	CAUTION (Max Limit)
🔴 Tier 4: Abort	> 20 mph sust. or > 25 mph gusts	ABSOLUTE NO-GO. Props remain in trailer / truck. Field props will not be fielded. Prop Lead notifies Directors and CBA judge.		NO-GO (Hold in Truck)

Why There Is No Emergency Lay-Flat Plan in This Handout

Previous operational drafts included field procedures for laying props flat on the turf during sudden gusts. For Adult Volunteer safety and competition clarity, **that procedure has been retired.** If 25–30 mph gusts are even remotely possible, the props will never be staged or moved onto the field.

2. Competition Day Schedule & Contact Information

Volunteers: Fill in the times and contacts below during morning check-in. Keep this sheet accessible in your pocket or clipboard throughout competition day.

Logistical Milestone	Scheduled Time	Specific Location / Gate Instructions
Competition & Venue	_____	Stadium: _____
Prop Lead of the Day	Name: _____	Cell Phone: (____) ____ - _____
Staging Area Location	Location / Area: _____	_____
Prop Staging Time	____ : ____ AM / PM	Staged once; props return here between Prelims & Finals
Equipment Truck Arrival	____ : ____ AM / PM	Parking Lot / Bay: _____
Adult Volunteer Call Time	____ : ____ AM / PM	Check-in at Equipment Trailer
Truck Unload & Assembly	____ : ____ AM / PM	Equipment Trailer Lot / Staging Lot
Band Warm-up Departure	____ : ____ AM / PM	Escort carts to Warm-up Zone / Gate
Prelims Prop Gate Queue	____ : ____ AM / PM	Rear Entrance Gate (Back Sideline)
Prelims Performance	____ : ____ AM / PM	T&P Clock Starts on Judge's Signal
Prelims Return to Staging	Immediate post-prelims	Return props to Staging Area between runs
Finals Gate Queue (if adv.)	____ : ____ AM / PM	Rear Entrance Gate
Finals Performance	____ : ____ AM / PM	Evening Performance Slot
Final Packdown & Depart	____ : ____ AM / PM	Trailer locked & ready for transit

3. Critical CBA Rules for Adult Volunteers

The Colorado Bandmasters Association (CBA) strictly enforces prop and adult volunteer regulations. **Penalties directly deduct points from the students' score.** Adhere strictly to the following:

⚠ Rule 9.07 — Field Passes

Maximum 25 wristbands per band. Every Adult Volunteer stepping past the gate must wear the official CBA wristband on their wrist (not in pocket or on badge). Prelims and Finals use different colors.

⚠ Rule 5.02 — Rear Entrance Mandate

Props must enter from the back sideline or rear end zone. Never wheel props across the front boundary line (reserved strictly for pit/percussion equipment). Handlers transit perimeter tracks.

⚠ Rule 4.03 & 5.06 — 3:15 Setup Window

The introductory announcement begins 3 minutes 15 seconds after judge's entry signal. **ALL adults must be completely clear of the field before the announcement ends.** Target all Adult Volunteers off turf by **2:45**.

⚠ Rule 4.03 — In-Show Turf Prohibition

Adult Volunteers are strictly forbidden from touching the field during the performance. 0.2-point penalty per occurrence. Once you exit, remain behind the front sideline or rear perimeter track.

⚠ Rule 8.05 — 2:00 Egress Clock

Timing clock begins on final chord. All equipment and personnel must clear field boundaries within 2 minutes. Once past the gate/tunnel threshold, carts pause in the exit chute to load the duck blinds.

⚠ Rule 8.05 — Double-Bagged Sandbags

All ballast sandbags must be heavy-duty and double-bagged with intact plastic inner liners. Leaking sand on synthetic turf results in severe facility fines and competition penalties.

4. 2026 Continuum Prop Fleet Summary

The 2026 visual design for **Continuum** incorporates three prop families totaling 30 field elements:

Prop Category	Quantity	Transport Unit	Field Placement	Crew Allocation
Duck Blinds (Sideline Screens)	16 screens (8 per side)	2 Rolling Carts (8 screens/cart)	Front Sideline (Side 1: 20–41 yd; Side 2: 59–80 yd)	2 Adult Volunteers (Pushers), 2 Student Unloaders, 16 Student Receivers
Rolling Backdrops	10 backdrops	10 Rolling Carts (1 cart/prop)	Backfield / Back Hash (Spanned across 30–70 yds)	2 Adult Volunteers (Managers), 20–40 Student Pushers (2–4 per backdrop)
Performance Stages	4 stages	4 Mobile Platforms (Integrated casters)	Midfield / Side Stages (Exact drill marks per show)	8 Adult Volunteers (2 handlers per stage platform)

5. Individual Job Descriptions & Step-by-Step Instructions

Find your assigned job card on the following pages. Each job is formatted as an independent, single-page operations sheet that can be printed and carried during competition day.

The field prop operation is organized into four primary divisions:

1. **Job Group A: Duck Blind Operations (Pages 4–7):** Divided into four specialized single-page job blocks covering cart pushing, rapid cart offloading, on-field concurrent deployment, and post-show egress.
2. **Job Group B: Rolling Backdrop Operations (Pages 8–10):** Divided into three specialized single-page job blocks covering adult backdrop managers (B.1), on-field student pushers (B.2), and off-field student pushers (B.3).
3. **Job Group C: Performance Stage Crew (Page 11):** Dedicated operations sheet for the 8 Adult Volunteers handling midfield mobile platforms.
4. **Job Group D: Prop Lead & Field Safety Coordinator (Page 11):** Master oversight, weather telemetry monitoring, judge liaison, and timing control.

Follow all instructions in strict sequential order. Adhere to all safety warnings and CBA competition boundaries.

Job Group A: Duck Blind Crew (16 Sideline Screens on 2 Dedicated Carts)

Job A.1: Adult Duck Blind Cart Pusher

Crew: 2 Adult Volunteers (1 per Cart: Side 1 or Side 2)

You will be in charge of one of two carts for transporting the duck blinds to and from the field. You will be in charge of ensuring it is loaded properly with 8 duck blinds and the correct amount of ballast, ensuring that it gets to the field on time, and removing the ballast from the field after the show. You will have student helpers to assist on field.

DAY-OF CART ASSIGNMENT:

Side: **Staging Location:**

☐ Side 1 (Right) Back _____ Yard Line

☐ Side 2 (Left)

DUCK BLIND BALLAST SCHEDULE:

Wind Regime		Per Blind (15-lb Bags)	Per Cart
Tier	MPH		
0	0–8	0 bags (dry frame)	0 bags
1	8–12	1–2 on ground (15–30 lb)	8–16 bags
2	12–18	2 ground + 1 hang (45 lb)	24 bags
3	18–22	2 ground + 2 hang (60 lb)	32 bags
4	>20	NO-GO (Hold in Trailer)	In Trailer

Complete Event Lifecycle (Truck → Staging → Field → Standby → Exit Chute → Staging/Truck):

- Arrival, Unload & Assembly:** Meet at the equipment trailer at the volunteer crew call time. Assist with unloading the props and pit equipment from the trucks and trailers. Assist with assembly of the props. Note: duck blinds are fully assembled, but the backdrops and stages both require multiple people to perform the assembly work.
- Move to Staging Area:** Move props and carts to the designated staging area at the designated staging time.
- Pre-Show Inspection:** Meet at the Staging Area 45 minutes prior to show time. Conduct a visual inspection of the cart, screen racks, and latches. Confirm sandbag quantity in the hopper matches the Ballast Schedule above (e.g., 8–16 bags for Tier 1; 24 bags for Tier 2; 32 bags for Tier 3). Push cart to the ready area as directed by the Prop Lead. Meet your assigned Student Unloader who will join you following their warm-ups.
- Field Staging A:** When directed by the on-field judge, enter the gates and stage at the prescribed location.
- Field Staging B:** When directed by the on-field judge, move to the defined yard line along the back sideline. **DO NOT CROSS THE SIDELINE MARKERS.** Doing so will immediately invoke an official penalty.
- Field Ingress & Directional Delivery:** When the CBA judge signals entry permission, push the cart forward toward the front sideline with your Student Unloader. When you reach the front sideline, turn and walk along the front sideline, pausing 6–8 seconds at each 2-yard mark while the unloader deposits one folded screen and sandbags to the pre-set student receiver.
- In-Show Standby at Sideline Boundary:** Once the 8th screen is delivered, immediately push the empty cart across the front boundary into the front staging area. **You must be completely off the turf before the 2:15 mark.** Park the cart ready for post-show egress. **Stay with your cart at the boundary for the entire performance.** Never step onto the turf during the show (Rule 4.03 penalty).
- Post-Show Ballast Sweep:** Once the show is completed, re-enter the front sideline at the far screen and move along the line of ballast bags you previously deposited. Scoop ballast bags placed on the turf by students directly into the cart hopper as you advance without doubling back. A student will be assigned to assist you in getting this done timely.
- Exit Chute Cart Loading:** We will be pausing at the exit chute with the carts to load the blinds. **DO NOT STOP FOR ANY LONGER THAN NECESSARY TO QUICKLY LOAD THE BLINDS.**
- Return to Staging Area or Truck:** Return the carts to the staging area (between Prelims and Finals), or directly to the trailer/truck if after Finals.
- Final Performance Teardown & Loading:** At the end of the final performance, tear down all equipment and assist with loading the truck and trailer.

Side 1 is on the right when standing on the backfield and facing the front stands.

Job Group A: Duck Blind Crew (Continued)**Job A.2: Student Duck Blind Cart Unloader**

Crew: 2 Student Performers / Crew (1 per Cart: Side 1 or Side 2)

Cart Operations & Rapid Offloading

Student Instructions: You accompany the Adult Cart Pusher from the rear gate to the front sideline, rapidly offload the 8 screens and assigned ballast bags to your fellow student performers, and clear the turf to take your opening drill position.

1. Rear Gate Rendezvous:

- Meet your assigned Adult Cart Pusher at the rear stadium entrance gate as directed by your section leader.
- Work with your section leader to get your instrument to your starting location on the field. The cart does not have instrument storage capabilities.
- Confirm with the Adult Cart Pusher the number of ballast bags to unload with each duck blind. Note this value will change depending on the wind conditions that day.

2. Perimeter Track Transit:

- Remain with the cart during entry and backfield staging as directed.

3. Field Entrance:

- When given the go-ahead by the on-field judge, move quickly with the cart straight forward to the front sideline.

4. Screen & Ballast Deposition (6-Second Drop Cadence):

- Once you reach the front sideline, walk along the sideline with the cart. As it rolls past each marked 2-yard line (screens 1 through 8):
 - Slide one folded screen off the cart rack.
 - Set the folded screen flat on the turf near the final location for that screen. Additional student helpers will be there to set the blind up.
 - Set the correct amount of ballast bags with each duck blind.
- Maintain a crisp, rapid pace: complete each handoff within **6 seconds** so the cart maintains forward momentum without stalling.
 - Repeat down the entire 8-screen line.

5. Field Clearance to Opening Show Drill Set:

- Once the 8th screen and final sandbags are deposited, briskly transition to your assigned opening performance location. You are now cleared for the show!

Job Group A: Duck Blind Crew (Continued)**Job A.3: Student Screen Deployment & Ballasting****Crew: 16 Student Performers (8 on Side 1, 8 on Side 2)****On-Field Screen Deployment & Rigidity**

Student Instructions: You are responsible for receiving, unfolding, latching, and ballasting the 16 duck blind sideline screens. You will be assigned one or more duck blinds to be your responsibility.

1. Pre-Show Field Positioning:

- March onto the field with the band during entry and proceed to your assigned front sideline coordinate. Coordinate with your section leader for instrument placement while you perform your duties.
- Stand at attention facing the backfield awaiting the arrival of your transport cart.

2. Receiving Screen & Ballast:

- As your transport cart arrives at your mark:
 - Receive 1 folded screen and ballast bags from the Student Unloader. Note that the ballast bag quantity will change based on wind conditions.
 - Place the folded screen standing vertically, display face toward the front audience.

3. Concurrent Unfolding & Lockup (15 Seconds):

- As soon as the screen is on the turf, all 8 performers on your side deploy simultaneously:
 - Swing the rear triangular support frame outward perpendicular to the front display panel.
 - Seat the snap clips (**I**) firmly into Rail 3 until fully engaged with an audible snap.
 - Adjust the position from center field outwards to ensure all blinds are aligned continuously into one front visual wall.

4. Ballast Installation:

- Place the ballast provided onto the duck blind in this order:
 - Place up to 2 bags across the rear ground rail.
 - Place up to 2 bags hanging from the top rail using the attached clips.

5. Rigidity Check & Show Posture:

- Give the frame a firm tap to confirm the snap clips and latches are fully seated and the screen is 100% rigid.
- Step back into your opening visual set posture before the introductory announcement ends.

Job Group A: Duck Blind Crew (Continued)**Job A.4: Student Screen Teardown & Egress****Crew: 16 Student Performers (8 on Side 1, 8 on Side 2)****Post-Show Deballasting & Egress Sprint**

Student Instructions: The 2-minute CBA egress clock starts the instant the final note of the show sounds. Disengage, collapse, and move your screens off the field quickly within the 2-minute egress window.

1. Immediate Teardown on Final Show Chord:

- After the show as directed by your section leader:
 - **Safe Ballast Placement:** Lift all sandbags off the rear ground rail and unclip any hanging bags; place them gently onto the synthetic turf next to the rail. **CRITICAL SAFETY MANDATE: NEVER THROW OR DROP SANDBAGS.** Dropping sandbags causes severe seam rupture and leaks sand, resulting in CBA score penalties. Place bags gently on the turf. Leave them in place for the Adult Cart Pusher to scoop during their sweep.
 - **Disengage Latches & Clips:** Disengage inter-screen side latches. Disengage snap clips (I) from Rail 3. Swing the cross arms up into alignment with the rear brace.
 - **Collapse Screen:** Swing the rear triangular brace flat against the front display frame.

2. The 35-Second Egress Sprint:

- Move quickly, hand-carrying the collapsed screens across the front sideline boundary and toward the designated stadium exit gate chute.

3. Replace on Cart:

- Exit the field to the pre-coordinated area to meet the cart rack.
- Replace screens in the transport cart racks (8 screens per cart).
- Rejoin the band.

Job Group B: Rolling Backdrop Crew (10 Backdrops on Dedicated Carts)**Job B.1: Adult Rolling Backdrop Managers****Crew: 2 Adult Volunteers (Overseeing Backdrops #1 through #10)****Assembly Supervision, Staging Logistics, Ballast & Student Oversight**

You are one of two Adult Volunteers in charge of the 10 rolling backdrops. You supervise and direct the assembly and disassembly of these props with assistance from prop and pit crew members, ensure all 10 props are transported to and from staging with appropriate wind ballast installed, and meet, supervise, and assist the student pusher teams at the staging area.

ROLLING BACKDROP BALLAST SCHEDULE (PER BACKDROP):

Tier	Wind MPH	15-lb Sandbags (Wing Iron Posts)	Supplemental Rail Ballast
Tier 0	0 – 8	0 bags (unballasted, 153 lb dry prop)	None
Tier 1	8 – 12	4 bags (2 per wing post, 60 lb ballast)	None
Tier 2	12 – 18	6 bags (3 per wing post, 90 lb ballast)	None
Tier 3	18 – 22	6 bags (3 per wing post, 90 lb ballast)	3 bags flat across rear 2x4 rail (45 lb)
Tier 4 (>20 mph)		ABSOLUTE NO-GO — Keep Locked in Equipment Trailer	

Step-by-Step Manager Lifecycle:

- Arrival & Assembly Supervision:** Meet at the equipment trailer at the Adult Volunteer call time. Supervise and direct the mechanical assembly of the 10 rolling backdrop carts (installing steel upright posts, diagonal struts, retaining pins, and vinyl banners with snap clamps). Direct help from other prop and pit crew members who may not have done this assembly before. Verify all strut pins and safety cotters are fully engaged.
- Ballast Installation & Pre-Staging Inspection:** Confirm the day's wind tier with the Prop Lead. Seat double-bagged 15-lb sandbags securely over the two vertical iron pipe posts on each cart per the table above (4 bags for Tier 1; 6 bags for Tier 2; 6 wing + 3 rear rail bags for Tier 3). Inspect swivel casters and confirm caster foot brakes are in the unlocked (UP) position for transit.
- Transport to Staging Area:** Lead the transport of all 10 ballasted backdrops from the trailer lot to the designated staging area at the designated staging time. Park carts in numerical order (1 through 10) and engage wheel brakes.
- Student Rendezvous & Supervision at Staging Area:** Meet the assigned Student Backdrop Pushers (2–4 students per backdrop) at the staging area 45 minutes prior to show time. Confirm each student team knows their backdrop number, entry queue sequence, and field position. Supervise and assist the students as they prepare for gate movement.
- Adult Field Boundary Rule:** Adults do not push backdrops onto the field. Clear behind stadium perimeter boundaries before the performance begins. **Never step onto the turf during the show (Rule 4.03 penalty).**
- Post-Show Reception & Return to Trailer:** Meet the student pushers as they return with the backdrops to the staging area following their end zone egress. Take custody of the backdrops from the students so they can rejoin the band block. Push the backdrops back to the staging area (between Prelims and Finals) or to the equipment trailer (after Finals).
- Post-Finals Disassembly Supervision:** Direct the safe deballasting (gently transfer sandbags into trailer totes; never drop or throw) and mechanical disassembly of frames for secure trailer packing.

Job Group B: Rolling Backdrop Crew (Continued)

Job B.2: Student Backdrop Pushers — On Field

Crew: 20–40 Students (2–4 per Backdrop, #1 through #10)

Staging Takeover, Backfield Entry & Show Positioning

Student Instructions: You are part of the team of 2 to 4 students assigned to roll your backdrop (1 through 10) from the staging area onto the field, position it at your marked coordinate, rotate it per training instructions, and lock it down for the performance.

1. Staging Area Takeover:

- Meet the Adult Backdrop Managers at the designated staging area 45 minutes prior to show time (following your section warm-ups).
- Locate your assigned backdrop (1 through 10).
- Coordinate with your section leader regarding instrument placement while performing your prop duties (the backdrop carts do not have instrument storage).

2. Perimeter Transit to Back Sideline:

- When directed by the Adult Managers / Prop Lead, take custody of your backdrop and roll it along the designated perimeter track toward the rear stadium entrance gate.
- Queue in strict numerical order (1 at front, 10 at rear).
- Always push using the wooden 2x4 frame uprights or dedicated push handles. **NEVER push directly against the vinyl display face.**

3. Back Sideline Staging:

- Move through the rear gate and stage along the back sideline directly in line with your final field coordinate.
- **CRITICAL BOUNDARY RULE: DO NOT CROSS THE BACK SIDELINE MARKERS.** Keep cart wheels completely behind the sideline until the on-field judge gives official entry permission. Doing so will immediately invoke a CBA penalty.

4. Field Ingress & Positioning:

- When the CBA judge signals entry permission, push your backdrop briskly straight forward onto the field toward your marked coordinate.
- Steer smoothly; avoid sharp pivots that could scrub or tear synthetic turf infill.
- Align the front edge of the wood base cart precisely with the yard line and hash mark specified on your coordinate sheet.

5. Orientation, Rotation & Brake Lock:

- Rotate the backdrop display face to the exact angle and orientation instructed during rehearsal training.
- **Immediately step on all four swivel caster foot brake levers to lock wheels.** Confirm the cart will not roll.
- Confirm all sandbags remain securely seated over the iron posts.

6. Transition to Opening Show Position:

- Once the backdrop is locked and rigid, briskly transition to your opening drill position or warm-up mark before the introductory announcement ends. You are now cleared for the show!

Job Group B: Rolling Backdrop Crew (Continued)**Job B.3: Student Backdrop Pushers — Off Field**

Crew: 20–40 Students (2–4 per Backdrop, #1 through #10)

Post-Show Egress Sprint & Staging Hand-Off

Student Instructions: The 2-minute CBA egress clock begins the instant the final note of the show sounds. You are responsible for immediately reaching your assigned backdrop, unlocking the brakes, rolling it off the field via the nearest front-half end zone route, and returning it to the staging area.

1. Immediate Post-Show Rendezvous:

- The instant the final cutoff chord sounds, move immediately to your assigned backdrop (1 through 10).
- **(Note: Your final closing drill position is coordinated so you finish nearest your assigned backdrop to eliminate cross-field transit lag.)**

2. Brake Release:

- Kick all four swivel caster foot brake levers UP into the UNLOCKED position.
- Confirm all 2 to 4 student handlers have secure two-handed grips on the wooden 2x4 frame uprights before rolling.

3. Straight-Line Egress to Front Half of End Zone:

- Push the backdrop in a straight line toward the closest point located on the **front half of the end zone** (away from the backfield pit/battery flow per CBA field clearance routing).
- Maintain brisk, continuous forward momentum. **NEVER stop on the turf to adjust equipment, rest, or talk.**
- Push strictly by the wooden framing uprights; **never push against the vinyl graphic face.**

4. Continuous Motion Past Gate to Staging Area:

- Roll through the end zone boundary line and directly into the stadium exit gate / tunnel chute.
- Per CBA Rule 8.05, maintain continuous motion through the tunnel—do not halt or de-ballast in the exit chute.
- Roll the backdrop along the perimeter path directly to the designated staging area.

5. Hand-Off to Adult Backdrop Managers:

- Park the backdrop in proper numerical alignment in the staging area.
- Step on the caster brake levers to lock wheels in place.
- Hand custody of the backdrop back to the Adult Backdrop Managers.
- Rejoin the band block for post-show debrief, uniform check, or awards ceremony.

Job Group C: Performance Stage Crew (4 Mobile Platforms, Stages 1 through 4)

Job C.1: Performance Stage Handlers

Crew: 8 Adult Volunteers (2 Handlers per Stage Platform)

Stages #1 through #4

1. **Staging & Safety Inspection:** Inspect your assigned stage platform. Verify decking surface is clean, dry, and non-slip. Confirm wheel lock levers and retractable leveling outriggers operate smoothly.
2. **Ingress & Positioning:** On the entry signal, two handlers push the stage platform from the rear gate to its designated performance mark. Avoid sudden pivoting on turf.
3. **Locking & Rigidity Verification:** Once at the mark, engage all caster wheel locks and extend/tighten stability outriggers until platform is 100% rigid. Give the platform a firm hand-shake to confirm zero wobble before student performers approach.
4. **Field Clearance:** Clear the performance field before the 2:45 mark and stand by at the nearest boundary.
5. **Post-Show Egress:** At the final chord, immediately return to the stage platform, retract outriggers, disengage wheel locks, and push the platform off the field through the exit gate in continuous motion to the trailer lot.

Job Group D: Prop Lead & Field Safety Coordinator

Job D.1: Prop Lead & Field Safety Coordinator

Crew: 1–2 Experienced Prop Directors / Leads

Overall Field Operations & Safety

1. **Weather Monitoring:** Carry a handheld digital anemometer and monitor live airport METAR weather feeds. Issue the **NO-GO** directive if wind speeds exceed 20 mph sustained or gusts reach 25–30 mph.
2. **Judge Liaison & Gate Release:** Coordinate directly with the CBA Timing & Penalty judge at the gate. Signal the prop crew the instant entry permission is granted.
3. **The 2:45 Clearance Call:** Monitor stopwatch. At 2:30, loudly call “**PROPS CLEAR!**” down the sideline and confirm all 25 Adult Volunteers are across the boundary line before the 3:15 announcement begins.
4. **Exit Chute Traffic Management:** Stand at the stadium exit gate during post-show egress to prevent cart bottle-necks and ensure continuous flow into the trailer parking lot.

6. Post-Show Deballasting & Trailer Packdown

All teardown and packdown procedures occur **exclusively in the equipment trailer parking lot** after clearing the stadium exit gate:

1. **Deballasting Safety:** Remove sandbags from backdrop retention posts and duck blind carts. Place bags gently into the designated heavy-duty storage totes inside the equipment trailer. **Never drop or throw sandbags** (protects seams and plastic liners).
2. **Screen Packing:** Stack collapsed sideline screens flat in the transport cart racks (8 screens per cart, hinges alternating to maintain coplanar nesting ≤ 2.0 inches). Secure retaining gate latches with 3D-printed locking pins.
3. **Trailer Loading:** Roll backdrops and carts into the trailer in reverse numerical order. Set wheel brakes, engage wheel chocks, and secure ratcheting cargo straps across each frame before transit.
4. **All-Clear Check:** Inspect the staging lot for personal belongings, water bottles, and tools. Verify all 25 Adult Volunteer wristbands are accounted for.

Competition Day Adult Volunteer Quick Reference Checklist

Before Entering Gate:

- Official CBA wristband secured to wrist (Rule 9.07)
- Arrive at trailer 45 minutes prior to step-off
- Verify all sandbags loaded on carts/props per Ballast Schedules
- Review assigned tasks & staging locations
- Check backdrop caster brakes in UNLOCKED position

On Field & Post-Show:

- Adult handlers: push stage platforms directly to mark on signal
- Lock all wheel brakes immediately upon arrival
- **Exit turf before 2:45** (behind front/back line)
- NEVER step onto field during the performance
- **Continuous motion** through exit gate to trailer lot!

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